

E-COMMERCE · SUSTAINABLE RETAIL

Verdé — shop plants sustainably, with confidence

An eco-conscious plant & planter store that turns anxious browsing into calm, informed buying — matching people to the right plant for their space and light.

ROLE

UX / UI Designer

TIMELINE

5 weeks

PLATFORM

Responsive Web + Mobile

TOOLS

Figma · Maze · Hotjar

01

The Problem

Buying plants online is surprisingly stressful. First-time buyers can't tell which plant suits their light and lifestyle, so they hesitate, abandon carts, or buy the wrong thing and return it.

Generic product grids treat a low-light succulent the same as a fussy fern. Without guidance on **care level, light needs and trust signals**, people default to “I’ll decide later” — and never come back.

PROBLEM STATEMENT

How might we help first-time plant buyers find the right plant for their space — and buy it with confidence?

70%

avg. e-commerce cart abandonment

3 in 5

first-timers unsure which plant fits

#1

return reason: “wrong for my space”

Goals & Success Metrics

Reduce decision anxiety and make the path from discovery to purchase calm and trustworthy.



Match, don't just list

Filter by light & care level so the catalogue fits the person.



Earn trust

Ratings, care difficulty and sustainability shown clearly on every card.



Frictionless mobile buy

A confident product page with a sticky add-to-cart.

Target metrics: product findability > 85% · add-to-cart success > 90% · SUS > 80 · fewer “wrong plant” doubts.

Understanding how people actually choose plants — and what stops them.

10 user interviews

Competitive audit — 6 stores

Card sorting (categories)

Analytics & heatmap review

Key findings

1 People filter by lifestyle, not taxonomy

"Low light", "hard to kill", "pet-safe" matter more than botanical categories.

2 Trust drives the purchase

Reviews and a visible care-difficulty rating were the strongest confidence signals.

3 The mobile product page is the moment of truth

Decisions happen there — it must answer every doubt without scrolling forever.

4 Sustainability must be shown

Eco claims only build trust when concrete (carbon-neutral shipping, biodegradable pots).

Personas



Priya Nair

29 · Marketing Lead · first-time plant parent

"I've killed two plants already. I just need something that survives my apartment and my schedule."

GOALS

- Find low-maintenance, low-light plants
- Feel reassured it'll actually thrive

FRUSTRATIONS

- No guidance on care difficulty
- Overwhelmed by huge catalogues



Ethan D'Souza

34 · Architect · design-conscious buyer

"I want plants that look considered and come from a brand that actually walks the sustainability talk."

GOALS

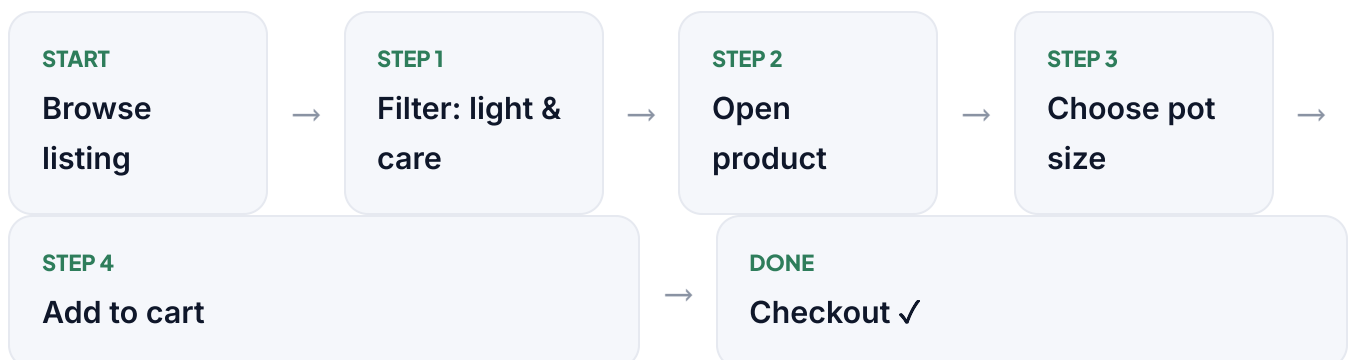
- Curated, aesthetic pieces & planters
- Verify eco credentials quickly

FRUSTRATIONS

- Vague "green" marketing
- Clunky checkout on mobile

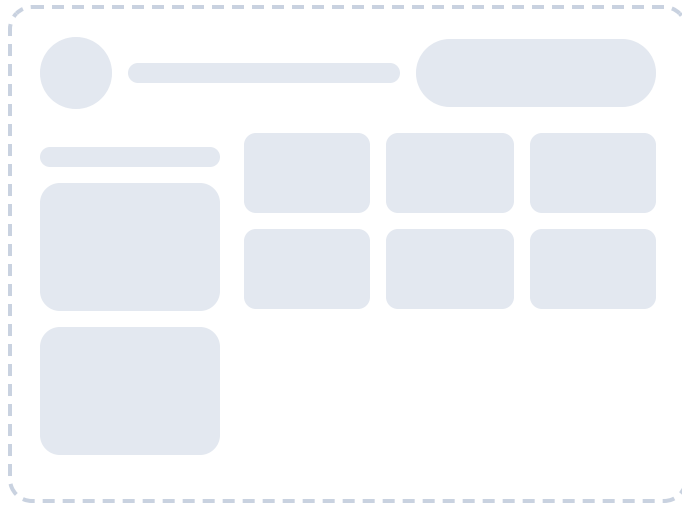
User Flow — Discover to Purchase

Filtering by lifestyle sits at the heart of the journey, feeding a confident product page.

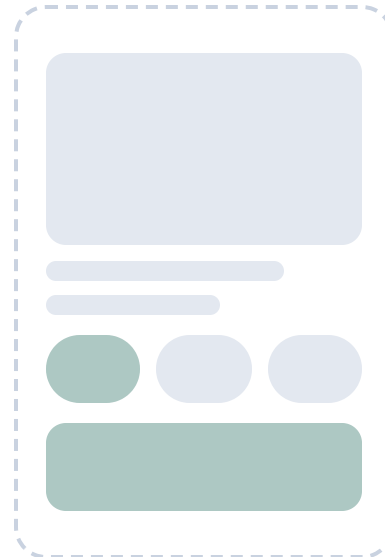


06 Wireframes

Low-fi layouts validated the filter-led listing and a single-decision product page before visual design.



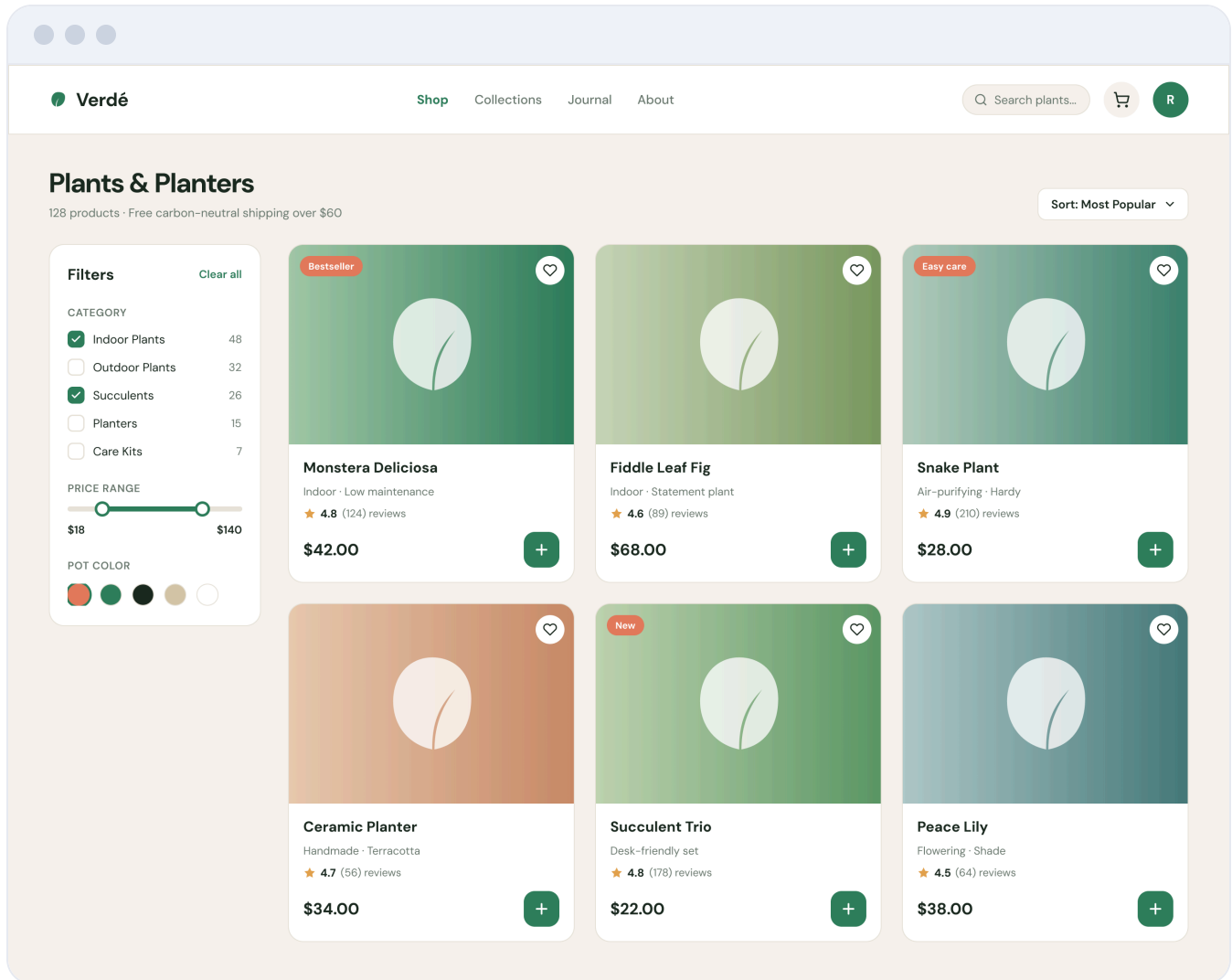
Desktop — filters sidebar + product grid



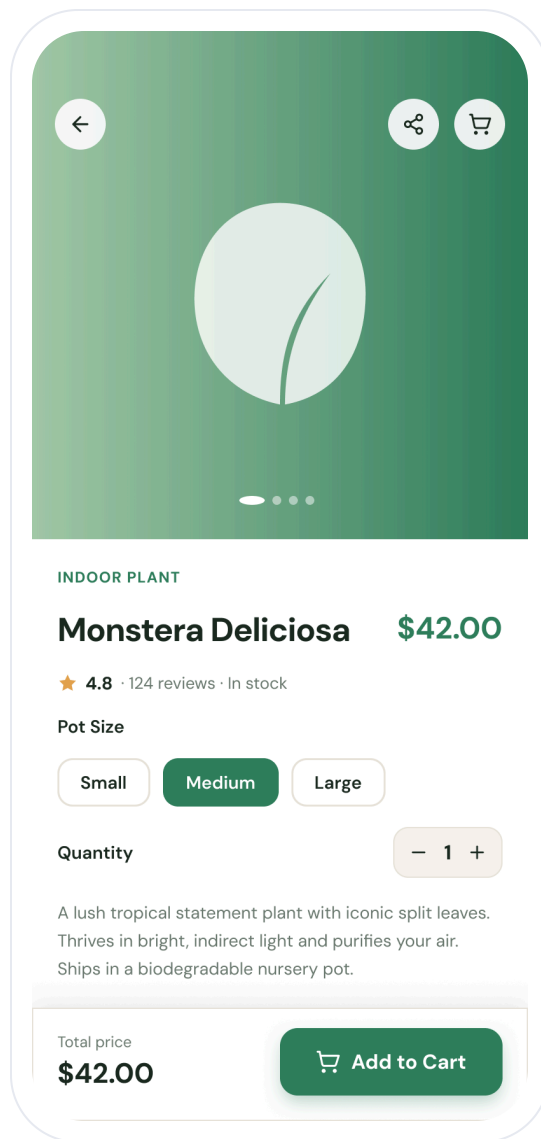
Mobile PDP — size pills + sticky CTA

Hi-Fi Design & Prototype

A calm, editorial storefront: a filter-led listing that matches people to plants, and a mobile product page that answers every doubt with a sticky add-to-cart.



Product listing (desktop) — filters, ratings & care signals



Product detail (mobile) — size selector, reviews & sticky cart

Key design decisions



Lifestyle filters

Care level, light and pot colour surfaced first — the way people actually shop.



Trust on every card

Ratings + review counts + free carbon-neutral shipping cues.



Sticky mobile add-to-cart

Price + CTA always in reach so the decision moment never scrolls away.

Usability Testing

6 participants, moderated + unmoderated, across the core shopping tasks.

Tasks: (1) "Find a low-light, easy-care plant under \$50." (2) "Add the Medium size to your cart."

METRIC	TARGET	RESULT
Product findability	> 85%	90%
Add-to-cart success	> 90%	96%
Avg. decision time	↓ vs. baseline	-38%
System Usability Scale	> 80	84

What testing changed

ITERATION 1

Care level was the top filter people looked for — but it was below the fold. → Promoted **care & light filters** to the top of the sidebar.

ITERATION 2

On mobile, size selection was missed. → Made **size pills larger** with a clearly selected state above the sticky CTA.

09

Results & Impact

96%

add-to-cart task
success

–38%

time to make a
decision

84

SUS score

**returns**

projected via
better matching

10

Reflection & Next Steps

Designing around **how people decide** — by light and care, not botany — mattered more than any visual polish. Card sorting early prevented a category structure users would have rejected.

Next: a “find my plant” quiz for total beginners, AR “see it in your space”, and post-purchase care reminders to reduce plant death (and returns).

UX Research

Card Sorting

IA

Responsive Design

Component Library

Usability Testing